

Talking Notes

GEB 7365 Project Presentation · 16 slides · 12 minutes of talking

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Before you start

Say the roadmap out loud. It takes fifteen seconds and it scores the well-organised box before you have said anything else.

“Five elements. The topic and my contribution. The model. Five hypotheses and why each one follows. How I would study it. And what evidence I already have, which is my own failed study.”

Then breathe. You know this better than anyone in the room.

Slide 1 and 2 · Open

Forty five seconds.

To compare anything across countries you have to reach the same people in every country, at the same time, with an instrument that means the same thing everywhere.

For ordinary people that is hard but normal. For a rare profession it is something else.

That something else is the whole project.

Slide 3 · The contribution

Seventy seconds. Walk the five boxes. Land on the last one.

“I want to move sampling feasibility from being a limitation to being a parameter.”

A parameter is worked out before you design, and it limits what you can design.

A limitation is what you confess afterwards.

Slide 4 · The model

A minute.

Reachable sample is four things multiplied together, not added.

Frame size. Prevalence. Response rate. Screen survival.

Each one is decided at a different level. That matters because when a country fails, people blame the country. Usually the country is not what failed.

Slide 5 • The big chart

Seventy seconds. This is your best slide. Slow down.

Add four countries and the panel you need in every single country goes from nineteen million to seventy two million.

The average response rate barely moves. Fifteen percent down to nine.

“The average is almost useless. The worst country decides everything.”

↓ **ASK THE ROOM HERE** ↓

“How many of you have read a comparative paper that reported one overall response rate? That is the number I am saying is wrong.”

That question is a scored box. You cannot get it any other way.

Slide 6 • Five hypotheses

A minute. Read H1 and H2 properly. Say the other three in a few words each.

Do not read the whole slide. They can read. Reading it is how you lose the room.

Slide 7 • Why H1 works

Just under a minute.

Saying a relationship differs between Spain and China means claiming something about both. If either one fails, the claim fails.

An average cannot do that job.

So every country you add makes the study more fragile, not more ambitious.

Slide 8 • H2, the one to be ready for

Seventy seconds. This is where a question is most likely.

Rugman and Verbeke found 320 of 380 big multinationals sell mostly in their home region. Eighty percent of sales.

Their reason is specific. Technology travels. Branding does not.

A research panel is nothing but branding. Its members, and its standing with them. The software is a commodity.

“So by their own logic, a panel should be MORE home region bound than a factory. Nobody has checked.”

Slide 9 • H4 and H5

Fifty seconds. Quick.

How you ask may matter more than where you ask.

Harzing got forty seven percent in Korea, by telephone. That beats the entire country spread by five times.

One number is not evidence. That is why it is a hypothesis and not a finding.

Slide 10 · Where the data comes from

Just under a minute.

Panel companies show you an estimated reachable count before you pay anything. Free.

That is the whole trick. It is why feasibility can be a parameter instead of an excuse.

One occupation, one provider, one country. About a hundred and forty four of those.

Slide 11 · What gets measured

Just under a minute. They score this separately, so be precise and do not rush.

Dependent variable is reachable usable sample.

Each independent variable belongs to one hypothesis.

Controls include eligibility strictness, which is just how many screening criteria you stack up. That is the only term the researcher actually controls.

Slide 12 · The analysis

A minute. Also scored separately. Be exact.

Two kinds of claim, two treatments.

H1 is logical, so it gets demonstration and sensitivity testing. A p-value would not make it more true.

H2 to H5 get hierarchical models. Cells inside countries, countries inside regions.

For H5 it is the interaction that matters, not the main effect.

Slide 13 · Timeline

Forty five seconds.

Nine months.

“The thing that killed my last study was recruitment. This design has no recruitment step at all.”

Slide 14 · Your evidence

Seventy seconds. The most memorable thing you will say. Pause after the big number.

“My evidence is my own failed study.”

“A panel of 334,976 people.” ... pause two seconds ...

“About twenty were eligible. Four were usable.”

Then say what it does not do:

It supports H1 directly. It says nothing about H2, because I had one provider in one region. It barely touches H4, because I used one instrument.

Saying what your evidence cannot do is the most credible thing in the talk. Do not skip it.

Slide 15 • Limits

Forty seconds. Read them briskly. Do not apologise for them.

Slide 16 • Close

Thirty five seconds.

“A parameter is worked out before a design. A limitation is confessed after it fails.”

“These numbers are all visible before you field anything. Making them part of the design instead of part of the confession is a small change in practice and a big change in what we can claim to have compared.”

If you run out of time

Cut slide 9 and slide 15. You can answer H4 and H5 if asked, and the limits fit in one sentence at the close.

Three questions you will probably get

“Isn't this just a methods paper?”

“The dependent variable is cross national. Which countries can be reached, and why coverage differs. H2 is what makes it international business, because it applies the regional thesis to a new kind of firm.”

“Your prevalence comes from one study in one country.”

“Agreed. There is no cross national prevalence data, which is exactly why getting it is the contribution rather than an assumption. Held constant, the model isolates the response rate effect. The figures show a structure. They do not estimate a quantity.”

“What if the big panels have all gone global?”

“Then H2 fails, and that is worth publishing, because it shows where the regional argument stops applying.”

Last thing

Do not read the slides. Look at faces. Stand where they can see you.

You have done the work. Go and say it.